

this is fast enough for the type of mobile ingest and offload workflows creators care about.

On iPhone, the workflow hinges on two points. First, you need USB-C, which means iPhone 15 series or newer. Lightning iPhones are out. Second, you want a straightforward way to manage files. SanDisk's Memory Zone app on iOS helps by making the external volume easy to browse, and it exposes a Record Direct-to-Drive option when the SSD is connected. That means you can point your camera app, or compatible capture tools, to write straight to the external SSD rather than internal storage. In practice, this removes the usual shuffle of shooting to phone, exporting, then cleaning up space, and it lets you keep internal storage free for apps and system tasks.

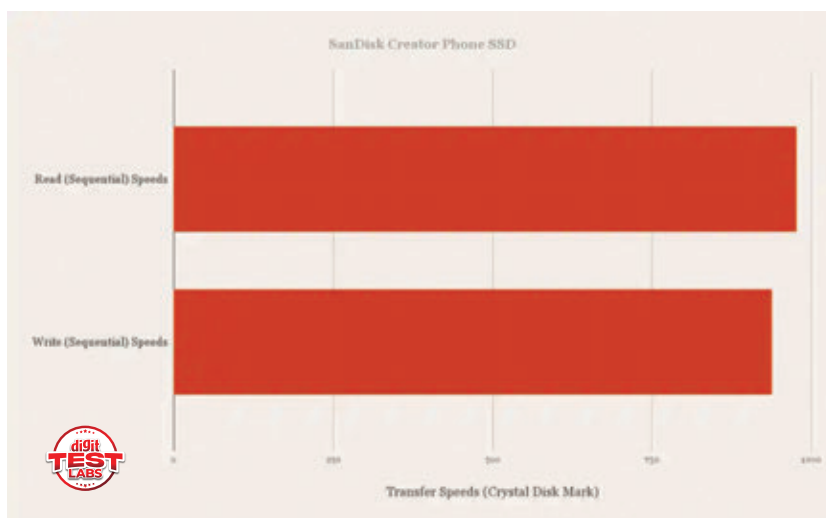
Thermals were sensible in our checks. After repeated large writes, the silicone shell felt warm, not hot, and speeds stayed consistent for multi-gigabyte transfers. The controller and NAND are clearly tuned for sustained mobile use rather than headline desktop benchmarks. If your workflow includes simultaneous power delivery and recording, note that power draw and data over a single port can get tricky with some hubs. A simple clean connection from phone to SSD is the most reliable approach when absolute stability matters.

SANDISK MEMORY ZONE APP

Because the drive is exFAT by default, you can pass it between iOS, macOS, Windows, and Android without needing to reformat it. That makes it ideal as a shuttle disk between a phone on set, a laptop in the coffee shop, and a workstation in the studio. If you prefer APFS or NTFS features, you can choose to reformat, but most creators will value frictionless hand-offs more than the filesystem extras.

VERDICT

SanDisk's Creator Phone SSD nails the brief for iPhone 15 (and above)



series shooters who need a compact, rugged, magnet-mountable scratch-pad that keeps pace with ProRes capture and quick offloads. The silicone shell and IP65 rating deliver practical resilience, the near-1 GB/s performance makes transfers painless, and the exFAT default keeps the drive plug-and-play across platforms. The



magnet mount reduces rig faff, and the Memory Zone app, with its Record Direct-to-Drive front door, helps turn a phone into a mini production rig with far fewer compromises.

There are limits. The appeal is sharply focused on USB-C iPhones, so anyone on older Lightning models is excluded. The included cable works, yet a right-angle connector at the phone end would have made the handheld

experience tidier. None of this undermines the core proposition, which is strong. For mobile creators, journalists, and social teams who have embraced iPhone workflows, this is a very neat way to reclaim internal storage, reduce friction, and keep shooting without pausing to delete.

If your needs are broader, for example heavy desktop editing or multi-device backup, a standard portable SSD might be better value. If your priority is a minimal mobile rig that lets you shoot, dump, and move on, the Creator Phone SSD is exactly the sort of tool that pays for itself the first time it saves a take.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

Form factor: External SSD | Available capacities: 2TB, 1TB | Interface: USB Type-C (USB 3.2 Gen 2) | Data Transfer Rates: Upto 1000 Mbps read, Upto 950 Mb/s write speed | Product Dimensions: 3.25 x 2.69 x 0.43 In | Packaging Dimensions: 1.30 x 4.21 x 5 In | Weight: 54 G | Operating Temperature: 0 C to 45 C | Compatibility: USB Type-C Devices (Smartphone, laptops, tablets)

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